

BRITISH TERRITORIAL EXPANSION (MYSORE, MARATHAS, SIKHS; SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE & LAPSE)

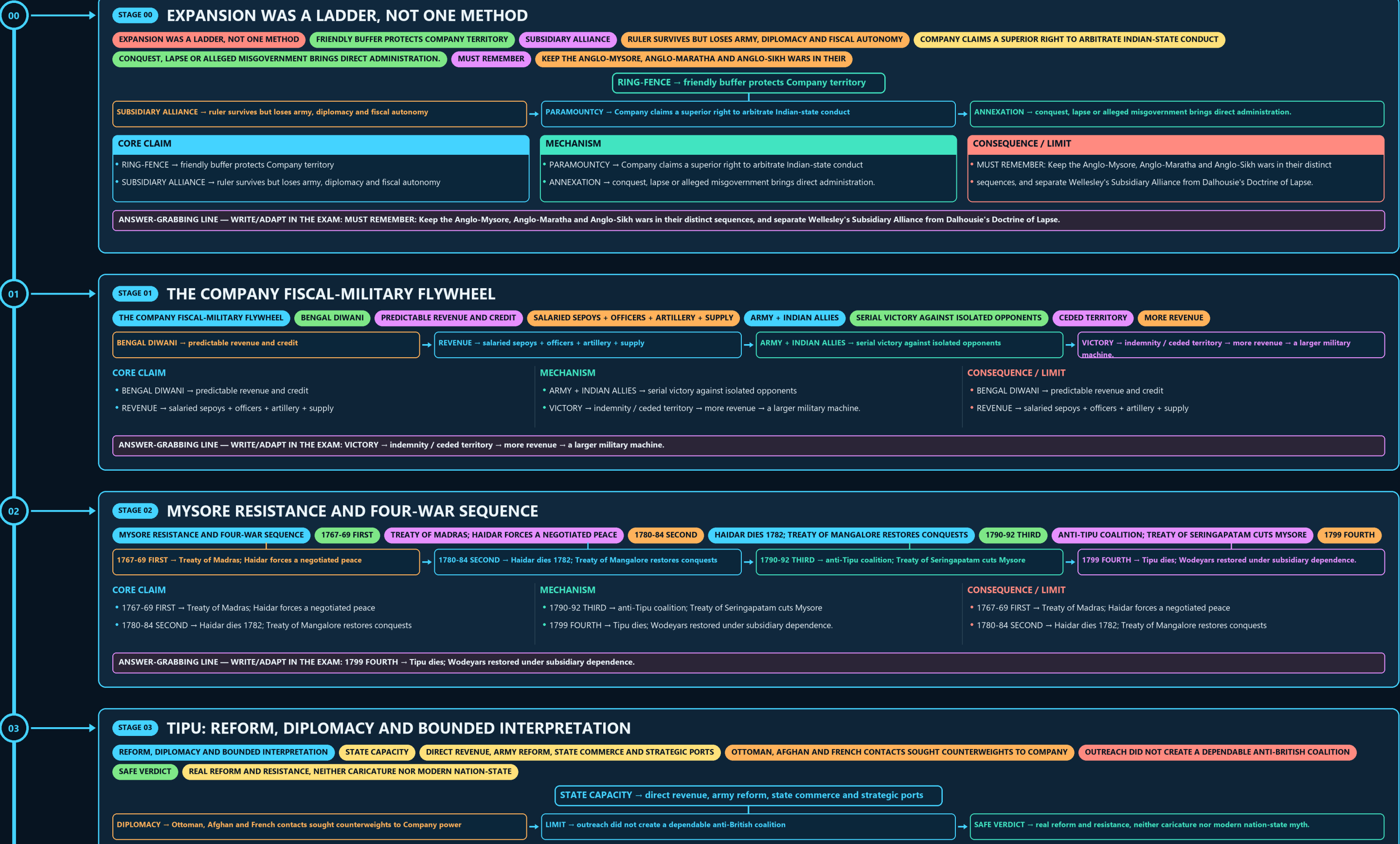
EXPANSION WAS A LADDER → THE COMPANY FISCAL-MILITARY FLYWHEEL → MYSORE RESISTANCE AND FOUR-WAR → TIPU: REFORM, DIPLOMACY AND → MARATHA CONFEDERACY AND THE → THREE ANGLO-MARATHA WARS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1799 FOURTH — Tipu dies; Wodeyars restored under subsidiary dependence.

03

STAGE 03 TIPU: REFORM, DIPLOMACY AND BOUNDED INTERPRETATION

REFORM, DIPLOMACY AND BOUNDED INTERPRETATION

STATE CAPACITY

DIRECT REVENUE, ARMY REFORM, STATE COMMERCE AND STRATEGIC PORTS

OTTOMAN, AFGHAN AND FRENCH CONTACTS SOUGHT COUNTERWEIGHTS TO COMPANY

OUTREACH DID NOT CREATE A DEPENDABLE ANTI-BRITISH COALITION

SAFE VERDICT

REAL REFORM AND RESISTANCE, NEITHER CARICATURE NOR MODERN NATION-STATE

STATE CAPACITY → direct revenue, army reform, state commerce and strategic ports

DIPLOMACY → Ottoman, Afghan and French contacts sought counterweights to Company power

LIMIT → outreach did not create a dependable anti-British coalition

SAFE VERDICT → real reform and resistance, neither caricature nor modern nation-state myth.

CORE CLAIM

- STATE CAPACITY → direct revenue, army reform, state commerce and strategic ports
- DIPLOMACY → Ottoman, Afghan and French contacts sought counterweights to Company power

MECHANISM

- LIMIT → outreach did not create a dependable anti-British coalition
- SAFE VERDICT → real reform and resistance, neither caricature nor modern nation-state myth.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- STATE CAPACITY → direct revenue, army reform, state commerce and strategic ports
- DIPLOMACY → Ottoman, Afghan and French contacts sought counterweights to Company power

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFE VERDICT → real reform and resistance, neither caricature nor modern nation-state myth.

04

STAGE 04 MARATHA CONFEDERACY AND THE COHESION PROBLEM

MARATHA CONFEDERACY AND THE COHESION PROBLEM

PESHWA AT PUNE

NOMINAL CONFEDERATE CENTRE

REGIONAL HOUSES WITH SEPARATE INTERESTS

REACH, CAVALRY, REVENUE CLAIMS AND EXPERIENCED COMMANDERS

NO DURABLE COMMON COMMAND; COMPANY BARGAINS AND FIGHTS ONE

PESHWA at Pune → nominal confederate centre

GAEKWAD → regional houses with separate interests

STRENGTH → reach, cavalry, revenue claims and experienced commanders

WEAKNESS → no durable common command; Company bargains and fights one house at a time.

CORE CLAIM

- PESHWA at Pune → nominal confederate centre
- GAEKWAD → regional houses with separate interests

MECHANISM

- STRENGTH → reach, cavalry, revenue claims and experienced commanders
- WEAKNESS → no durable common command; Company bargains and fights one house at a time.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PESHWA at Pune → nominal confederate centre
- GAEKWAD → regional houses with separate interests

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WEAKNESS → no durable common command; Company bargains and fights one house at a time.

05

STAGE 05 THREE ANGLO-MARATHA WARS

THREE ANGLO-MARATHA WARS

1775-82 FIRST

RAGHUNATH RAO CRISIS

WADGAON REVERSE

TREATY OF SALBAI

1802 BASSEIN

PESHWA ACCEPTS SUBSIDIARY TERMS AFTER HOLKAR'S VICTORY

1803-05 SECOND

1775-82 FIRST → Raghunath Rao crisis → Wadgaon reverse → Treaty of Salbai

1802 BASSEIN → Peshwa accepts subsidiary terms after Holkar's victory

1803-05 SECOND → Scindia and Bhonsle defeated; Holkar resists and settlement follows

1817-18 THIRD → Peshwaship abolished; Baji Rao II pensioned at Bithur.

CORE CLAIM

- 1775-82 FIRST → Raghunath Rao crisis → Wadgaon reverse → Treaty of Salbai
- 1802 BASSEIN → Peshwa accepts subsidiary terms after Holkar's victory

MECHANISM

- 1803-05 SECOND → Scindia and Bhonsle defeated; Holkar resists and settlement follows
- 1817-18 THIRD → Peshwaship abolished; Baji Rao II pensioned at Bithur.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 1775-82 FIRST → Raghunath Rao crisis → Wadgaon reverse → Treaty of Salbai
- 1802 BASSEIN → Peshwa accepts subsidiary terms after Holkar's victory

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1817-18 THIRD → Peshwaship abolished; Baji Rao II pensioned at Bithur.

06

STAGE 06 SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE DISMANTLED SOVEREIGNTY

SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE DISMANTLED SOVEREIGNTY

BRITISH FORCE STATIONED

RULER PAYS CASH OR CEDES REVENUE TERRITORY

RESIDENT AT COURT

CONTINUOUS POLITICAL LEVERAGE

NO INDEPENDENT WAR

EUROPEAN EMPLOYMENT

EXTERNAL SOVEREIGNTY REMOVED

BRITISH FORCE STATIONED → ruler pays cash or cedes revenue territory

RESIDENT AT COURT → continuous political leverage

NO INDEPENDENT WAR / DIPLOMACY / EUROPEAN EMPLOYMENT → external sovereignty removed

RESULT → protection without capacity; ruler bears blame for a state Britain constrains.

CORE CLAIM

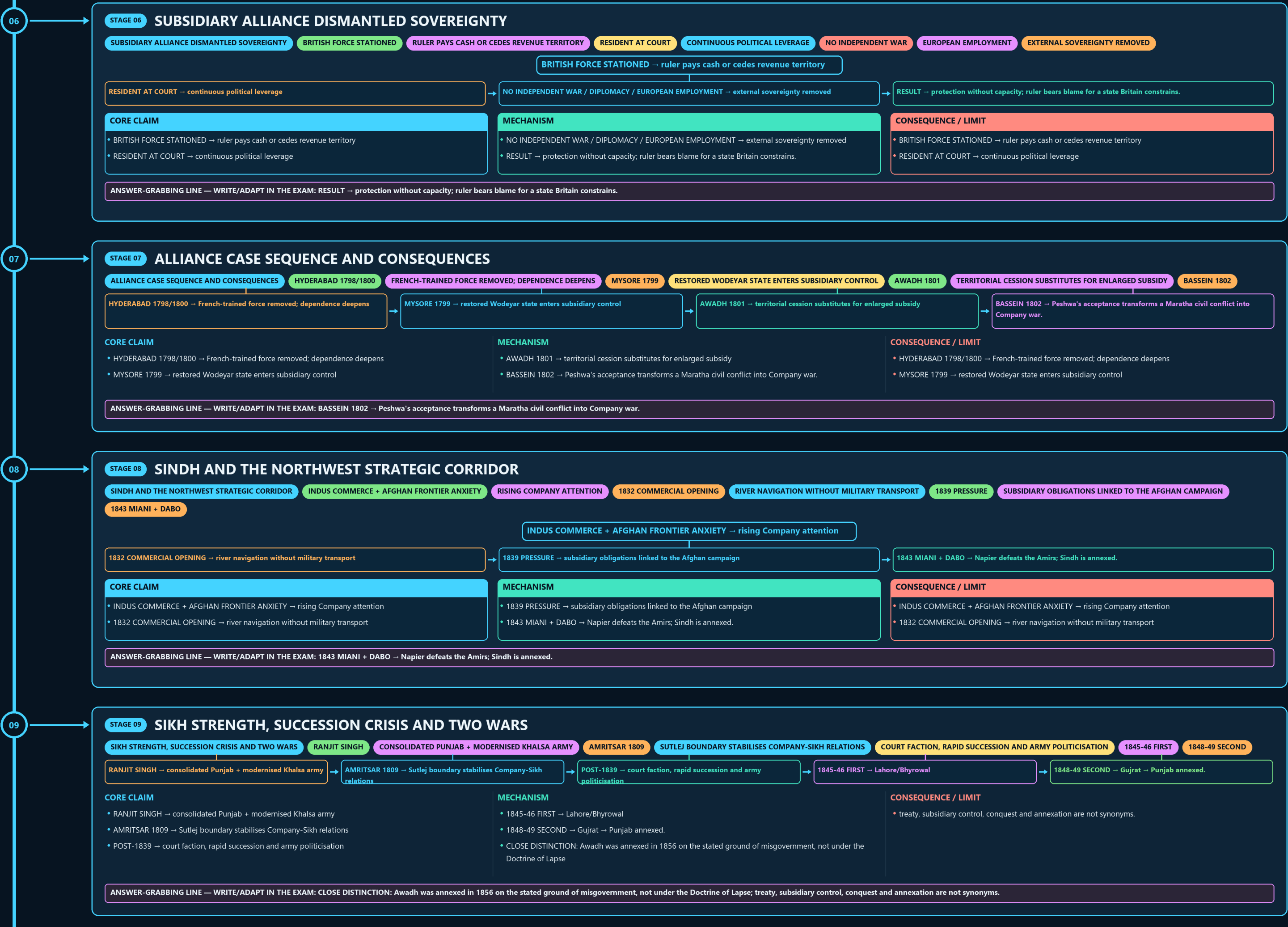
- BRITISH FORCE STATIONED → ruler pays cash or cedes revenue territory
- RESIDENT AT COURT → continuous political leverage

MECHANISM

- NO INDEPENDENT WAR / DIPLOMACY / EUROPEAN EMPLOYMENT → external sovereignty removed
- RESULT → protection without capacity; ruler bears blame for a state Britain constrains.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- BRITISH FORCE STATIONED → ruler pays cash or cedes revenue territory
- RESIDENT AT COURT → continuous political leverage



SIKH STRENGTH, SUCCESSION CRISIS AND TWO WARS

RANJIT SINGH

CONSOLIDATED PUNJAB + MODERNISED KHALSA ARMY

AMRITSAR 1809

SUTLEJ BOUNDARY STABILISES COMPANY-SIKH RELATIONS

COURT FACTION, RAPID SUCCESSION AND ARMY POLITICISATION

1845-46 FIRST

1848-49 SECOND

RANJIT SINGH → consolidated Punjab + modernised Khalsa army

→

AMRITSAR 1809 → Sutlej boundary stabilises Company-Sikh relations

→

POST-1839 → court faction, rapid succession and army politicisation

→

1845-46 FIRST → Lahore/Bhyrowal

→

1848-49 SECOND → Gujrat → Punjab annexed.

CORE CLAIM

- RANJIT SINGH → consolidated Punjab + modernised Khalsa army
- AMRITSAR 1809 → Sutlej boundary stabilises Company-Sikh relations
- POST-1839 → court faction, rapid succession and army politicisation

MECHANISM

- 1845-46 FIRST → Lahore/Bhyrowal
- 1848-49 SECOND → Gujrat → Punjab annexed.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Awadh was annexed in 1856 on the stated ground of misgovernment, not under the Doctrine of Lapse

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- treaty, subsidiary control, conquest and annexation are not synonyms.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Awadh was annexed in 1856 on the stated ground of misgovernment, not under the Doctrine of Lapse; treaty, subsidiary control, conquest and annexation are not synonyms.

10

STAGE 10

LAPSE, TITLE DENIAL AND MISGOVERNMENT ARE DISTINCT

LAPSE, TITLE DENIAL AND MISGOVERNMENT ARE DISTINCT

ADOPTED HEIR NOT RECOGNISED

SATARA, JHANSI AND NAGPUR ANNEXED

PENSION DENIAL

NANA SAHIB'S PENSION CLAIM IS NOT A TERRITORIAL LAPSE

AWADH ANNEXED IN 1856 DESPITE A RECOGNISED RULING DYNASTY

EXAM RULE

IDENTIFY THE LEGAL PRETEXT BEFORE NAMING THE ANNEXATION POLICY.

CORE CLAIM

LAPSE → adopted heir not recognised → Satara, Jhansi and Nagpur annexed

TITLE / PENSION DENIAL → Nana Sahib's pension claim is not a territorial lapse case

MECHANISM

MISGOVERNMENT → Awadh annexed in 1856 despite a recognised ruling dynasty

EXAM RULE → identify the legal pretext before naming the annexation policy.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Campaign maps, treaty clauses, succession disputes and Indian alliance choices

qualify any account of uniform British military superiority or passive regional defeat.

CORE CLAIM

- LAPSE → adopted heir not recognised → Satara, Jhansi and Nagpur annexed
- TITLE / PENSION DENIAL → Nana Sahib's pension claim is not a territorial lapse case

MECHANISM

- MISGOVERNMENT → Awadh annexed in 1856 despite a recognised ruling dynasty
- EXAM RULE → identify the legal pretext before naming the annexation policy.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Campaign maps, treaty clauses, succession disputes and Indian alliance choices
- qualify any account of uniform British military superiority or passive regional defeat.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXAM RULE → identify the legal pretext before naming the annexation policy.

11

STAGE 11

COMPARATIVE ANSWER SPINE AND 1857 BRIDGE

COMPARATIVE ANSWER SPINE AND 1857 BRIDGE

CENTRALISED REFORM BUT DIPLOMATIC ISOLATION

WIDE CONFEDERATE POWER BUT FRACTURED COMMAND

STRONG ARMY AND STATE UNDER RANJIT SINGH; DESTABILISED AFTER

1857 BRIDGE

DISPOSSESSED RULERS, TALUQDARS AND SOLDIERS ADD GRIEVANCES, NOT ONE

MYSORE → centralised reform but diplomatic isolation

→

MARATHAS → wide confederate power but fractured command

→

SIKHS → strong army and state under Ranjit Singh; destabilised after 1839

→

1857 BRIDGE → dispossessed rulers, taluqdars and soldiers add grievances, not one cause.

CORE CLAIM

- MYSORE → centralised reform but diplomatic isolation
- MARATHAS → wide confederate power but fractured command

MECHANISM

- SIKHS → strong army and state under Ranjit Singh; destabilised after 1839
- 1857 BRIDGE → dispossessed rulers, taluqdars and soldiers add grievances, not one cause.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MYSORE → centralised reform but diplomatic isolation
- MARATHAS → wide confederate power but fractured command

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1857 BRIDGE → dispossessed rulers, taluqdars and soldiers add grievances, not one cause.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

EARLY COMPANY POLICY OFTEN SOUGHT BUFFERS, BUT AFTER BENGAL

INCREASINGLY USED WAR, DIPLOMACY, RESIDENTS AND SUBSIDIES TO DOMINATE

WELLESLEY'S SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE TRANSFORMED RULERS INTO DEPENDENT ALLIES

THEY HOSTED BRITISH

TROOPS, PAID SUBSIDIES, ACCEPTED A RESIDENT AND SURRENDERED INDEPENDENT

THIS PRODUCED INDIRECT RULE

INDIAN RULERS SURVIVED FORMALLY, BUT SOVEREIGNTY SHIFTED TO THE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Early Company policy often sought buffers, but after Bengal the Company
- increasingly used war, diplomacy, Residents and subsidies to dominate Indian states.
- Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance transformed rulers into dependent allies: they hosted British
- troops, paid subsidies, accepted a Resident and surrendered independent external relations.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- CAUTION: This produced indirect rule : Indian rulers survived formally, but sovereignty shifted to the Company.
- Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse moved from indirect control to annexation by denying adoption rights in selected states.
- Awadh's annexation in 1856 used the separate justification of alleged misgovernance, showing that British expansion used multiple legal pretexts.
- Mysore under Haider Ali and Tipu Sultan resisted through military reform, diplomacy and attempts to balance British power.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Maratha weakness lay in confederate rivalries; British diplomacy exploited divisions among the Peshwa, Scindia, Holkar, Bhonsle and Gaekwad.
- Sikh power was consolidated under Ranjit Singh, but after his death court
- factionalism and military tensions enabled British victory in the Anglo-Sikh wars.
- CAUTION: Bengal revenues, sepoy armies and superior logistics allowed the Company to fight repeated wars far beyond its original coastal bases.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.